

MS Word Fundamentals

Lesson 22 — Interface and Core Document Operations

JKSSB Computer Awareness

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What MS Word Is

- ▶ **MS Word** (Microsoft Word) is a **word processor** used to create, edit, format, and print text documents.
- ▶ It is part of the **Microsoft Office** suite.
- ▶ A Word document is saved as a file, commonly with the **.docx** extension.
- ▶ The window shows the **document area**, the **Ribbon**, the **Quick Access Toolbar**, and the **status bar**.

The one idea

A word processor separates **typing** the text from **formatting** its appearance, so the same words can be shown in many ways.

The Ribbon and Its Tabs

- ▶ The **Ribbon** is the strip of commands across the top of the window; it replaced the old menu bars.
- ▶ Commands are grouped under **tabs**: Home, Insert, Design, Layout, References, Mailings, Review, and View.
- ▶ Every tab is divided into **groups** (for example, the Home tab contains Font, Paragraph, and Styles groups).
- ▶ Some tabs are **contextual**: they appear only when a table or picture is selected (Table Tools, Picture Format).

Exam point

The **Home** tab holds the most-used formatting commands: font and paragraph tools.

The Quick Access Toolbar

- ▶ The **Quick Access Toolbar (QAT)** is the small row of buttons at the top-left corner.
- ▶ By default it shows **Save**, **Undo**, and **Redo**.
- ▶ It can be **customised** to hold any command you use often.
- ▶ It can be moved below the Ribbon if you prefer.

Why it matters

The QAT stays visible on every tab, so the commands placed on it are always one click away.

Creating, Opening and Saving Documents

- ▶ The **File** tab opens **Backstage view**, where New, Open, Save, Save As, Print, and Close live.
- ▶ **Ctrl+N** creates a new blank document; **Ctrl+O** opens an existing one.
- ▶ **Ctrl+S** saves the document; **Save As** saves a copy under a new name or in a new location.
- ▶ The default Word format is **.docx**; older documents use **.doc**.

Exam point

Ctrl+S = Save. **Save As** is used to store a **copy** with a different name, location, or format.

Entering and Editing Text

- ▶ New text is typed at the **insertion point** (the blinking cursor).
- ▶ **Word wrap** moves text to the next line automatically; Enter starts a **new paragraph**.
- ▶ **Backspace** deletes the character to the left; **Delete** deletes the character to the right.
- ▶ **Ctrl+Z** undoes the last action; **Ctrl+Y** redoes it.

Selecting text

A **word** is selected by double-click; a **paragraph** by triple-click; the whole document by **Ctrl+A**.

Font Formatting

- ▶ The **Font** group on the Home tab changes how characters *look*.
- ▶ It sets the **font face** (typeface) and **font size**.
- ▶ Style buttons: **Bold (Ctrl+B)**, **Italic (Ctrl+I)**, **Underline (Ctrl+U)**.
- ▶ It also sets **font colour**, **highlight**, and effects such as subscript and superscript.

Worked example

To make a heading stand out: select it, choose a larger font size, apply **Bold**, and pick a darker font colour.

Paragraph Alignment

- ▶ **Alignment** fixes where each line sits between the margins.
- ▶ **Left (Ctrl+L)**: text lines up on the left — the default.
- ▶ **Centre (Ctrl+E)**: each line is centred.
- ▶ **Right (Ctrl+R)**: text lines up on the right.
- ▶ **Justify (Ctrl+J)**: text is flush at both left and right margins.

Exam point

Justify stretches spaces so both edges are even; **centre** does not.

Indentation

- ▶ **Indentation** pushes paragraph lines inward from the margin.
- ▶ **Left indent** and **right indent** move the whole paragraph inward.
- ▶ **First-line indent**: only the first line is pushed inward.
- ▶ **Hanging indent**: every line *except* the first is pushed inward — used for reference lists.

Do not confuse

Indentation shifts lines horizontally; **spacing** changes the vertical gaps between lines and paragraphs.

Line and Paragraph Spacing

- ▶ **Line spacing** controls the vertical gap between lines within a paragraph (for example, single, 1.5, double).
- ▶ **Paragraph spacing** controls the gap **before** and **after** a paragraph.
- ▶ Both are set from the Home tab's Paragraph group or the Paragraph dialog box.
- ▶ Spacing keeps a document readable without adding blank lines manually.

Bullets and Numbering

- ▶ **Bullets** mark items with a symbol, for unordered lists.
- ▶ **Numbering** marks items with numbers or letters, for ordered lists.
- ▶ **Multilevel lists** combine levels (1, 1.1, 1.1.1) for nested outlines.
- ▶ All three are applied from the **Paragraph** group on the Home tab.

Exam point

Use **bullets** when order does not matter; use **numbering** when order or sequence matters.

Tables

- ▶ A **table** arranges text in **rows** and **columns**; each intersection is a **cell**.
- ▶ Insert one from **Insert** → **Table**.
- ▶ Cells can be **merged** into one or **split** apart.
- ▶ Rows and columns can be inserted, deleted, and resized.

Worked example

A marks table: three columns (Roll No., Name, Marks) and one row per student.

Table Tools tabs appear only while the table is selected.

Images and Objects

- ▶ **Insert** → **Pictures** places an image into the document.
- ▶ Handles on the image let you **resize** and rotate it.
- ▶ **Text wrapping** decides how text flows around the image (In Line with Text, Square, Tight, Behind Text, and so on).
- ▶ Charts, shapes, and SmartArt are inserted from the same **Insert** tab.

Exam point

“**In Line with Text**” treats the image like a character; the other wrapping styles let text flow around it.

Headers and Footers

- ▶ A **header** is the area at the **top** of each page; a **footer** is the area at the **bottom**.
- ▶ They repeat on **every page** of a section.
- ▶ Insert them from **Insert** → **Header / Footer**.
- ▶ Common uses: document title in the header, **page numbers** in the footer.

Remember

Header = top of the page; footer = bottom of the page.

Page Setup

- ▶ **Page setup** is found on the **Layout** tab.
- ▶ **Margins**: the blank space between text and the page edges.
- ▶ **Orientation**: **Portrait** (tall) or **Landscape** (wide).
- ▶ **Page size**: for example A4 or Letter.
- ▶ The same tab sets **columns** and page **breaks**.

Exam point

Portrait is taller than wide; Landscape is wider than tall. This is a frequent options trap.

Page Break vs Section Break

- ▶ A **Page Break** (**Ctrl+Enter**) starts the next content on a **new page**; formatting remains the same.
- ▶ A **Section Break** starts a new **section**, which can have its own page setup.
- ▶ Only a **Section Break** lets a part of the document have **different headers and footers**.
- ▶ Both are inserted from **Layout** → **Breaks**.

Trap alert

A **Page Break** does **not** change headers and footers. Changing them needs a **Section Break**. (TRAP-13)

Printing a Document

- ▶ **Ctrl+P** opens the **Print** screen in Backstage view.
- ▶ The **print preview** shows exactly how the pages will appear.
- ▶ You can choose the **printer**, the **copies**, and which **pages** to print.
- ▶ Clicking **Print** sends the document to the selected printer.

Before printing

Always check the print preview: it catches wrong margins, stray blank pages, and cut-off text before paper is used.

Lesson 22: Recall

- ▶ **MS Word** is a word processor; **.docx** is its default file format.
- ▶ The **Ribbon** carries tabs and groups; the **Home** tab holds font and paragraph tools.
- ▶ The **Quick Access Toolbar** sits at the top-left and is customisable.
- ▶ **Ctrl+S** saves, **Ctrl+P** prints, and **Ctrl+Enter** inserts a page break.
- ▶ Font tools change character appearance; paragraph tools change alignment, indentation, and spacing.
- ▶ **Bullets** are unordered; **numbering** is ordered.
- ▶ A **Section Break** (not a Page Break) allows different headers and footers.
(TRAP-13)